

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

The background of the slide features a close-up, slightly blurred image of the United States flag and the Indian national flag. The US flag's stars and stripes are visible on the left, while the Indian flag's saffron, white, and green horizontal stripes, along with the Ashoka Chakra in the center, are on the right.

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INDO-US RELATIONS

- 1 Indo-US bilateral relations have developed into a **global strategic partnership** based on shared democratic values and increasing **convergence of interests** at bilateral, regional and global level- promoting global security, stability, and economic prosperity through trade, investment, and connectivity.
- 2 The two largest democracies, thus, contribute to stability and prosperity of the world.
- 3 Former President Obama said that India-US relationship has the potential of becoming **'one of the defining partnerships of the 21st Century'**.

The relationship can be discussed by dividing into several phases-

- Cold War period
- Post Cold War
- Contemporary relationship



After independence, India was pursuing the policy of Non-Alignment and PM Nehru was inclined towards USSR.

1. BAGHDAD PACT 1955

- Indo-US relations have always been complicated because of the Pakistan factor.
- It started in 1955 when Pakistan aligned with the US through South East Asian Treaty Organization (SEATO) and Central Asian Treaty Organization (CENTO) also known as the Baghdad Pact.
- Pakistan became important for the US for the prevention of communist incursions in the Middle East and containment of USSR.

2. 1962 INDIA-CHINA WAR

- During the 1962 India-China War, US extended help to India by sending an American carrier to Bay of Bengal.
- The Indian community welcomed American intervention.



3. 1971 WAR

- 1** PM Gandhi met President Nixon when the problem in East Pakistan was creating a refugee crisis in India.
- 2** USA refused to acknowledge it as an international issue and did not support India
- 3** During the 1971 Indo-Pak war, US sent its naval force to the Bay of Bengal and threatened India to withdraw its forces. USSR, ultimately, came to the rescue of India by placing its naval fleet as well

4. FRIENDSHIP WITH USSR

- 1** India and US started drifting further when India signed Treaty of Peace, Friendship and Cooperation with USSR in 1971.
- 2** In response to this, US President Richard Nixon suspended \$87 million worth of economic aid to India.
- 3** But after Emergency, the US eased restrictions it had placed on World Bank loans to India and approved direct economic assistance of \$60 million.

5. 1974 NUCLEAR TEST

1 India detonated its first nuclear device, and became the first nation outside the five permanent members of the UN Security Council to have declared nuclear capabilities.

2 In response, US enacted the Nuclear Non Proliferation Act, which requires countries like India not included in the Nonproliferation Treaty, to allow inspections of all nuclear facilities by the International Atomic Energy Agency.

3 India refused the same and US ended nuclear assistance to India

4 It led to estrangement between the United States and India that lasted for two decades.



6. PM GANDHI'S VISIT TO US

- 1 PM Indira Gandhi visited US in 1982 to improve relations between countries
- 2 The leaders agreed to increase cooperation and resolve disputes over nuclear power
- 3 By this time, the US was planning on upgrading its presence at Diego Garcia, an island in the Indian Ocean controlled by the British.

7. INTERNATIONAL SECURITY

- In 1980, India faced serious security problems when the US extended large amounts of military aid into Pakistan to fight proxy wars against USSR in Afghanistan.
- In 1990, India helped the US in the Gulf War with logistic support for American military operations.
- India's role in the Gulf War was widely appreciated.



1. LPG REFORMS

- 1 With the disintegration of USSR in 1989, USA was the only superpower and the hegemon in the world. It was a paradigm shift in the geopolitics of the world.
- 2 US encouraged foreign investment after India's economic reforms of Liberalisation, Privatization and Globalisation.
- 3 This immensely enhanced trade relations between the two countries.



2. NUCLEAR TESTS OF 1998

- 1 The Indian government announced the success of a series of underground nuclear tests close to the border with Pakistan, surpassing U.S. intelligence organizations.
- 2 It made US apprehensive of the possibility of a regional nuclear arms race
- 3 It affected India's relationship with the United States.
- 4 President Bill Clinton imposed economic sanctions on India

3. US PRESIDENT'S VISIT TO INDIA

- 1 President Bill Clinton was the first U.S. presidential to visit India since 1978.
- 2 The visit ended the estrangement of the post-1998 Indian nuclear weapons tests
- 3 In 2001, President Bush's administration lifted all remaining U.S. sanctions imposed on India after 1998.
- 4 Visa restrictions for Israeli citizens was also relaxed.

4. RELATIONS WITH ISRAEL

- 1 In the post-Cold War period, India was forced to 'Look West' and build relations with Israel
- 2 On 29 January, 1992, India established full-fledged diplomatic relations with Israel.
- 3 This was done after India convinced Palestinian leader Arafat of the need for better relationship with Israel.
- 4 Thus, diplomatic relations with Israel were established and balance with Palestine was maintained.



The contemporary relationship has the following several dimensions

1. Political
2. Geo-Strategic
3. Defence
4. Maritime Security
5. Counter-terrorism
6. Cyber Security
7. Economic
8. Multilateral Cooperation
9. Energy and Climate Change
10. Space Technology
11. Science and Technology
12. Educational Cooperation
13. People-to-people ties



POLITICAL

1. DEMOCRATIC VALUES

- 1 India is an indispensable partner of the US as India is the largest democracy of the world.
- 2 The partnership is founded on a shared commitment to freedom, democratic principles, equal treatment of all citizens, human rights, and the rule of law.
- 3 Indo-US relations are known to spread peace and prosperity, contain nuclear proliferation and spread of weapons of mass destruction in the world.



POLITICAL

2. CONVERGENCE OF INTERESTS

- 1 President Barack Obama announced 'Rebalancing' to Asia, as a part of his 'Pivot to Asia' policy which essentially meant maintaining conventional deterrence in the face of Chinese military modernisation.

This policy is important because-

- Effective military presence in Asia-Pacific is necessary to maintain conventional deterrence and preserve peace.
- Have the necessary preparedness in the event of a sudden attack.
- Indian Navy will be important for the US in this achieving this.



GEO-STRATEGIC

- 1 India is an important partner of the US to contain China in Asia, and manage Afghanistan and Pakistan.
- 2 The Indian Ocean is geo-strategically important as it is a part of the global Sea Lanes of Communication (SLOCs) between the East and West, including oil and petroleum traffic. US-led international efforts can act as a check on Chinese proliferation activity in the Indian Ocean, Malabar exercise, South China Sea.
- 3 India's western border is a part of the terror affected areas of the world which starts from North Africa and runs through Middle East to Pakistan and India.



GEO-STRATEGIC

4 India has strong diplomatic ties with countries of Middle East and Latin American countries and Indian culture and goodwill has enhanced its soft power in West Asia, South America, Africa and South-east Asia. These holds strategic value for the US.

5 The 2017 National Security Strategy said the U.S. welcomes “India’s emergence as a leading global power and stronger strategic and defense partner.” It declared unequivocally that the U.S. “will expand our defense and security partnership with India.”



DEFENCE

- 1 Defence cooperation between the United States and India is a strategic priority for both nations, but the pace and scope of cooperation on defence technology and trade has been impeded by differing bureaucratic processes and legal requirements.
- 2 US says it supports India's indigenous defence industry and aspirations of becoming a regional power.
- 3 A 'New Framework for India-US Defence Relations' in 2005 led to the intensification in defence, trade, joint exercises, personnel exchanges, collaboration and cooperation, maritime security and counter piracy.



DEFENCE PROCUREMENTS

DEFENCE

- 1 The US is the third-leading supplier of weapons to India, accounting for 12% of the country's defence imports.
- 2 Since 2008, India has bought or ordered military equipment worth \$15 billion from the US, including C-130J special operations planes, C-17 transport aircraft, P-8I submarine hunter planes, Harpoon missiles, Apache and Chinook helicopters and M777 lightweight howitzers.
- 3 India requested U.S. for the purchase of 24 MH-60R Multi-Role Helicopters (MRH) for the Navy for \$2 billion.

DEADLY MISSILE SHIELD

DEAL | 5 squadrons of S-400 Triumf anti-aircraft/anti-missile systems from Russia

COST | ₹39,000cr

CHARACTERISTICS

- S-400 can destroy hostile aircraft, stealth fighters, missiles & drones at 400-km range
- Radars (primary acquisition one has 600-km range) can track hundreds of targets simultaneously
- 4 kinds of missiles to intercept targets at different ranges
- Can intercept even ballistic missiles with velocity of 4,800 meters per second
- Russia boasts S-400 can even "radar lock & shoot down" 5th-Gen stealth fighters like American F-35 jets

PLAN:

- Induct 1st S-400 squadron in 2 years after contract inked. All 5 in 5 years
- IAF will integrate S-400 with its IACCS (integrated air command and control system) network of sensors & weapons

CHINA:

inducting six S-400 batteries under a \$3 billion deal with Russia in 2014



DEFENCE PROCUREMENTS

DEFENCE

4 In 2019, the Indian Air Force received its first tranche of U.S.-made Apache attack helicopters, replacing inferior Soviet-era airframes. This acquisition paved the way for a number of bilateral attack aviation training opportunities.

5 At Howdy Modi in 2019, President Trump said that the two countries have conducted defence hardware trade around USD 18 billion over the last 10 years and many more defence deals were in the pipeline.



DEFENCE

INDO-US NUCLEAR DEAL (2008)

This deal is a watershed event in Indo-US relations.

- 1
 - It provided US assistance to India in its civilian nuclear energy program
 - It expanded Indo-US cooperation in energy and satellite technology.

UNDER THIS PROGRAM

- 1 India agreed to allow IAEA inspectors to get access to their civilian nuclear program.
- 2 India agreed to continue its moratorium on nuclear weapons testing.
- 3 India committed to strengthening security of its nuclear arsenal.



DEFENCE

INDO-US NUCLEAR DEAL (2008)

UNDER THIS PROGRAM

- 4 India would prevent spread of enrichment and reprocessing technology to states that do not possess them and support non-proliferation.
- 5 US companies were allowed to build nuclear reactors in India and provide nuclear fuel for its civilian nuclear program.

SHORTCOMINGS

- 1 One of the biggest concerns for India is Section 17b of the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Bill, 2010.
- 2 Under this bill, the operators cannot seek recourse in case of nuclear accidents because of defects in material, equipment or services provided.



DEFENCE

NATIONAL DEFENCE AUTHORISATION ACT (NDAA) OF 2017

- 1** The amendment in the National Defence Authorisation Act (NDAA) of 2017 designated India as a major defence partner of the US. This is important because India is a non-NATO ally of US.
- 2** This step institutionalises the progress made by the US to facilitate defence trade and technology sharing with India to a level at par with its closest allies and partners.
- 3** It will strengthen institutional effectiveness of India and will facilitate US to transfer advances defence technology to India.



DEFENCE

NATIONAL DEFENCE AUTHORISATION ACT (NDAA) OF 2017

As a part of this amendment, several deals were signed between India and US

- Fuel Exchange Agreement
- Technical Agreement on Information Sharing on White Shipping
- Information Exchange Annex on Aircraft Carrier Technology

1 In April 2019, Indian and the US Navies held a joint submarine hunting exercise in the Indian Ocean, aiming to lay the groundwork for coordinating maritime patrol and reconnaissance, according to the US Navy



DEFENCE

NATIONAL DEFENCE AUTHORISATION ACT (NDAA) OF 2017

- 2** The Spruance and VP-8 are operating with the 7th Fleet, which is the largest forward deployed fleet of the US and operates in the Indo-Pacific region, which is the focus of India-US strategic cooperation.
- 3** India acquired the first of its Boeing manufactured P-8Is in 2012
- 4** US approved the sale of 24 submarine-hunting MH-60R Seahawk Multi-Mission helicopters to India for \$2.6 billion



DEFENCE

2+2 SUMMIT

The 2+2 Summit between India and US strengthened strategic relations through the landmark agreement.

1 The 2016 Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement provides formal access to each country's military facilities for fueling and logistical support

2 India and US signed the Communications, Compatibility and Security Agreement (COMCASA) in 2018.

3 By this, US can transfer secure communication and data equipment to India and offer real time data sharing with Indian military.

4 COMCASA agreements could reduce the chances of US imposing sanctions on India for looking to buy Russian S-400 surface to air missile.



DEFENCE

MILITARY EXERCISES

- 1 India participated in the Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) exercise in July-August 2016.
- 2 The Air Forces of India and the U.S. conducted a 12-day military exercise in the Kalaikunda and Panagarh air bases in West Bengal in December 2018 with an aim to enhance operational coordination.
- 3 The 'Ex Cope India-18' was the fourth edition in the series of bilateral drills between the Indian Air Force and the U.S. Air Force.
- 4 The aim of the exercise was to provide operational exposure and undertake mutual exchange of best practices towards enhancing operational capability
- 5 India and US also agreed to open a hotline between the foreign heads and hold joint exercises involving the air force, navy and army off the East coast in 2019.



DEFENCE

MILITARY EXERCISE- TIGER TRIUMPH

- 1 India and the United States held their **first tri-services** exercise code-named "Tiger Triumph" at Visakhapatnam and Kakinada in November 2019.
- 2 It was the **second such tri-service** to be performed by India with a nation **other than Russia** highlighting the **strong and growing bilateral defence ties** between India and America.
- 3 Both the teams from the US and India also visited the campsite at Kakinada and conducted table-top exercises as preparatory activities.
- 4 US Marine Corps and a Special Forces reconnaissance team, Indian Navy's P8i long-range maritime reconnaissance and anti-submarine warfare aircraft, among others participated.
- 5 The 'harbor phase' was decided to held be in Visakhapatnam from November 13 to 16 and the second phase in Kakinada from November 17 to 21.



DEFENCE

MILITARY EXERCISE- TIGER TRIUMPH

IMPORTANCE OF THE EXERCISE

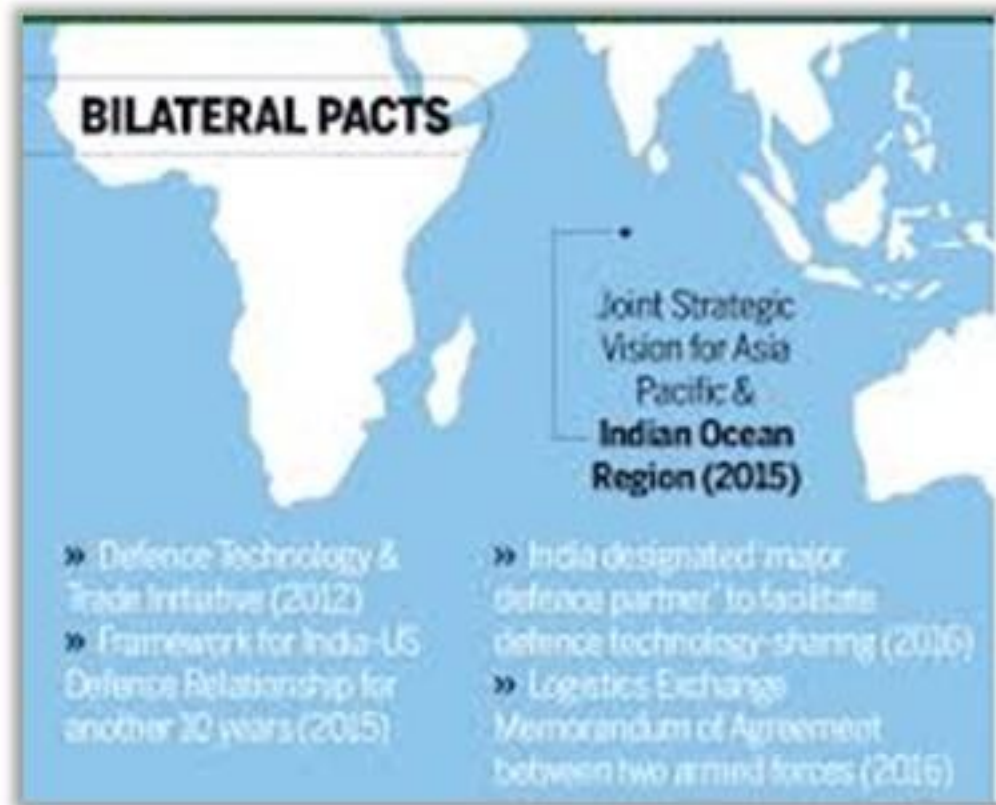
- 1 Tiger Triumph was to increase U.S.-Indian military interoperability and effectiveness.
- 2 It also forged important relationships between the two militaries and expand U.S. regional knowledge.
- 3 The exercise represented a tangible and necessary implementation of a series of U.S. strategic pronouncements regarding the importance of U.S. international partnerships in general and India in particular.
- 4 U.S. needed strong partners and allies to defend shared interests and deter great power adversaries.



DEFENCE

DEFENCE TECHNOLOGY AND TRADE INITIATIVE (DTTI)

- 1 In 2012, the Defence Technology and Trade Initiative (DTTI) was undertaken.
- 2 It is a flexible mechanism to ensure that senior leaders from India and US are focused on the opportunities and challenges associated with growing our defence partnership.



DEFENCE

DEFENCE TECHNOLOGY AND TRADE INITIATIVE (DTTI)

AIM OF THE DTTI

- 1 Transform the bilateral defence relationship into one that is limited only by independent strategic decisions
- 2 Remove bureaucratic obstacles or inefficient procedures
- 3 Strengthen India's defence industrial base by moving away from the traditional "buyer-seller" dynamic toward a more collaborative approach
- 4 Explore new areas of technological collaboration from science and technology cooperation through co-development and co-production.



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